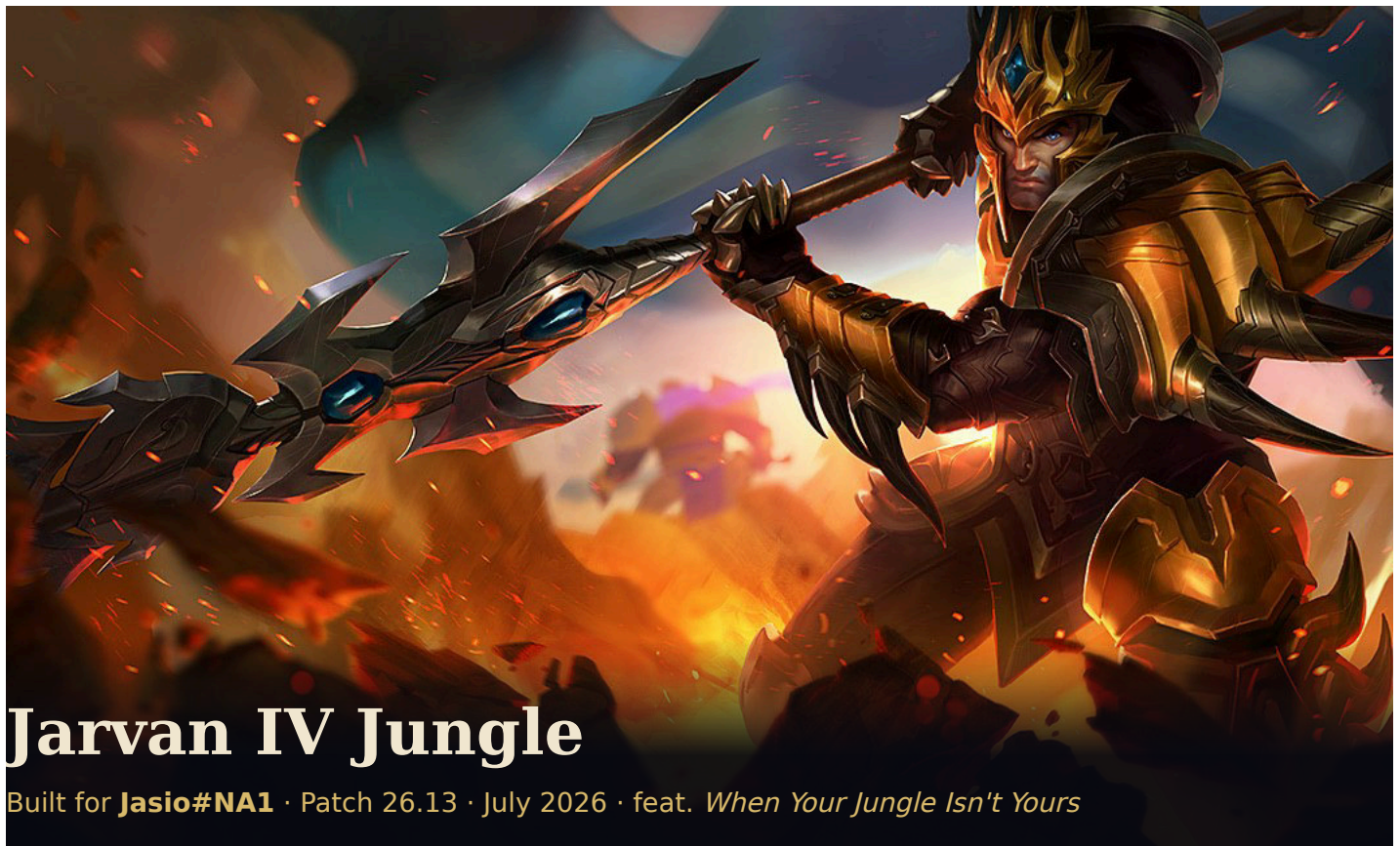




Jarvan IV Jungle

Built for **Jasio#NA1** · Patch 26.13 · July 2026 · feat. *When Your Jungle Isn't Yours*

How to read the labels: **VERIFIED** multi-source, adversarially fact-checked · **SINGLE SOURCE** one reputable source · **REASONING** game-knowledge, verify in your own games. Stats are lolalytics patch 26.13, Emerald+ unless marked. Requested by Campbell (soup minion#NA1); a special chapter covers your question — *what do I do when I'm constantly invaded?* — in §6.

1 • The Snapshot

VERIFIED Jarvan IV is **S- tier, the #7 jungler of 77** at Emerald+ (52.1% WR, n=153,547) and **#6 of 80 at Gold** (50.4%, n=94,060) on 26.13. He hasn't been patched since 25.19 — everything here is stable, not flavor-of-the-month.

VERIFIED **You, specifically** (op.gg, 2026-07-06): Platinum 3 solo queue, 59% WR — climbing. Your Jarvan is 4 games old, all **top lane**, and it's working (3W-1L, 5.7 KDA, 71% kill participation) — this guide moves that success to jungle. Your current jungle volume pick is Nunu (13W-18L, 42%), and your Nunu losses cluster against early duelists who invade: **Viego 0-3, Kayn 0-2, Lee Sin 0-2**. That's not a coincidence — it's the exact problem §6 exists to solve, and J4 handles all three of those matchups at even-or-better (§7). One more number from your recent games: **zero control wards** in your last four. Hold that thought until §6c.

REASONING What he is: the best **level-2-3 engage jungler** in the game — E-Q knockup is a gank that works from behind a wall, before most junglers have a gank at all. What he is **not**: a 1v1 duelist (dedicated duelists beat him in isolated fights — see §6 and §7) or a late-game carry (he falls off; his job after 25 minutes is engage + peel, not damage). Your whole game plan flows from this: **use early tempo to bank objectives, then cash out before scaling junglers outgrow you.**

2 · The Kit — Numbers That Matter

Ability	What it actually does
 P · Martial Cadence	VERIFIED First basic attack on each target: 8% of their CURRENT health as bonus physical damage (min 20). Capped at 400 vs monsters only — uncapped vs champions . Per-target cooldown 6/5/4/3s by level. Jungle engine: first hit on every buff is huge. In fights: auto early while they're full HP , and spread autos across fresh targets.
 Q · Dragon Strike	VERIFIED 90-250 (+145% bonus AD) physical in a line, shreds 10-26% of armor for 3s , CD 10→6s, 0.4s cast. If the lance touches your E flag, you dash to it, knocking up everything on the path for 0.75s — and the dash executes even if you're rooted or grounded when it connects.
 W · Golden Aegis	VERIFIED Shield 60-140 (+70% bonus AD) +1.3% of your max HP per enemy champion hit (4s), and slows all of them 15-35% for 2s. Flat 9s CD. Rule: cast it after you land in their team, not before — every champion in the 625 radius makes it bigger.
 E · Demacian Standard	VERIFIED Passive: +20-30% attack speed, permanently (this is why it's your level-1 skill for clearing). Active: flag deals 80-240 magic, stands 8s, gives the same AS aura to nearby allies (radius 1000). Range 860, no cast time — which is what makes the instant E-Q possible.
 R · Cataclysm	VERIFIED 200/325/450 (+180% bonus AD) physical, 0.35s displacement-immune leap, then a 3.5s ring of real terrain . Enemies near the edge get shoved out; everyone else gets pulled in. Recast (available after 0.75s) collapses the wall. It IS crossable by dashes and Flash — R traps immobile champions, not mobile ones. CD 120/105/90.

3 • Combos

Combo	Buttons	When & why
Instant E-Q (the gank)	E+Q same instant	E has no cast time, so buffering both fires a near-instant 0.75s knockup at ~770 range. This is your bread and butter — from fog, over walls, before they can react.
Full gank string	E→Q → AA → W → (R)	Knockup → auto (passive chunk while they're full HP) → W slow so they can't walk away when the knockup ends. R only if they'll escape or to wall off help.
EQ-Flash	E→Q, Flash mid-dash	VERIFIED Flash during the E-Q dash: the dash stops but the knockup still applies at your new position. Direction correction — they sidestep, you Flash the knockup back onto them.
Jail-break	R → E outside wall → Q	Trap them in R, then E-Q over your own wall and leave. The cage stays up 3.5s without you in it. Use when their team collapses or you're low.
Escape E-Q	E over terrain → Q	Your only escape — a wall-hop on a ~10-12s cooldown. If you burned E-Q engaging and the fight turns, you are not leaving. Decide before you jump.
R discipline	R center-mass; recast when done	Land R so the target is inside , not on the rim (rim = shoved out). Recast the moment the kill is secured — a standing cage traps your own immobile teammates too.

VERIFIED Tech notes: the E-Q pull executes even while immobilized (rooted mid-dash still pulls). Enemies dodge R with any dash/blink — hold it until their dash is down, or use it as a **wall** (cut a choke, block a path) rather than a cage vs mobile champs. W's slow is your gank stick pre-6: E-Q → AA → W keeps them in auto range for your laner.

4 · Runes & Build

Piece	Choice	Notes
Keystone	 Conqueror (Precision)	VERIFIED 94.3% pick, 52.1% WR (n=144,761). Nothing else is close — your fights are extended skirmishes and Conqueror stacks fully in them.
Minors	Triumph · Legend: Alacrity · Coup de Grace	VERIFIED The standard page. Directional upgrades: Legend: Haste 53.4% (n=7,139), Cut Down 52.7% vs 2+ tanks (n=15,234).
Secondary	Inspiration: Cosmic Insight + Magical Footwear	VERIFIED 77% of pages, 52.4%. Shards: Attack Speed / Adaptive / Health.
Summoners & start	Flash + Smite ·  Scorchclaw pup + potion	VERIFIED Flash+Smite is 99.9% of games. Scorchclaw (red pet) 63% pick; its slow-and-burn helps ganks stick.

VERIFIED Skill order: **E at 1** (attack speed for the clear) → Q at 2 → W at 3 (83.5%). Max **Q > E > W**, R at 6/11/16 — 95% consensus, 53.0% WR.

4a · Two builds, not a pile of items

REASONING The most common Plat itemization mistake is buying five individually good items that don't cooperate. J4 has exactly two coherent builds, and every purchase should know which one it belongs to. The numbers below are **ordered pairs** — "what people who bought X first actually bought second, and how it went" — which is much stronger evidence than the usual per-slot popularity tables.

Path	Order	Why & when
A · Bruiser (your default)	 Sundered Sky → boots →  Black Cleaver →  Death's Dance / defense (\$4c)	VERIFIED The mass-consensus line: Sundered→Cleaver, 53.1% over n=50,352 — the single most-played and best-proven pair. With Mercs in the middle: 53.7% (n=15,078). REASONING Hidden synergy: these two carry +800 HP , and your W shields +1.3% of max HP <i>per champion hit</i> — the bruiser path literally buys you a bigger Aegis. Take this when even or behind, into bruisers/tanks, or whenever unsure.
B · Tempo lethality (ahead by first back)	 Profane Hydra →  Axiom Arc → boots →  DD /  Serylda's	VERIFIED The stat-winning line: Profane→Axiom 54.9% (n=16,256) , and Profane→Axiom→Death's Dance hits 56.8% (n=1,862). Faster clears (Cleave splash), and kills feed Axiom's Flux into more Cataclysms — R's 180% bonus-AD ratio loves the flat AD. But it's a <i>lead multiplier</i> : two squishy damage items and no HP means it amplifies whatever game state you're in. Ahead = snowball; behind = paper.
The bridge	 Eclipse first, decide later	VERIFIED Eclipse→Sundered: 52.9% (n=14,350). Eclipse procs trivially off E-Q+auto (6% max-HP hit + shield) and commits you to neither path. Fine pick when the game's unreadable at first back — but don't follow it with Cleaver (50.4%, n=2,366, below champion average).

The Axiom question — is one lethality item ever worth it?

A sharp question came up while building this guide: *Axiom Arc's 55.4% win rate at second item looks great — but is it any good without Profane Hydra in front of it?* Short answer: **no, and the evidence agrees three separate ways.**

VERIFIED 1. The players have already voted. Of 153,547 games, Sundered→Axiom was played **33 times**. Axiom's whole slot-2 win rate is Profane-first games wearing a disguise; as a *first* item Axiom is the worst on the list (51.0%, n=518). Nobody builds it alone, and the few who try don't prosper.

VERIFIED 2. The armor math is superlinear. Lethality is flat armor pen, and each point is worth more as armor approaches zero. Against an 80-armor squishy: first 18-lethality item = **+11% damage**; the second = **+14 more** (+25% total); a third = +39.5% total. The *second* lethality item outperforms the first — they recruit each other. Meanwhile, against a 220-armor tank one lethality item is worth just +6%, where Cleaver's 30% shred stacked with your own max-rank Q (another 26%) is worth **~+50%**. One lethality item in a bruiser build is the worst point on the whole curve.

VERIFIED 3. Axiom itself pays for lethality. Since 26.09, Flux refunds **10% (+0.25% per point of lethality)** of R's cooldown on takedown. Axiom alone: 14.5% per takedown. With Profane: 19%. Add Edge of Night: 22.8%. The item's own passive scales with committing to the archetype.

REASONING Verdict: Axiom is a Path B item, full stop. On Path A your second item is Black Cleaver and there is no "but I'm getting takedowns" exception — takedowns on Path A are what Cleaver stacks and Death's Dance resets are for.

4b · Damage items — what each one is for

Item	Stats (wiki-verified 26.13)	The job
 Sundered Sky 3100g	45 AD, 400 HP, 10 AH · next basic vs each champ auto-crits and heals ~base AD + 6% missing HP (10s per target)	Path A opener. The forgiveness item — every skirmish starts with a crit-heal, and like your passive it re-procs per fresh target. 51.5% as first item but the pair data (§4a) is what sells it.
 Black Cleaver 3000g	40 AD, 400 HP, 20 AH · physical damage stacks Carve: 6% armor <i>reduction</i> per stack, 30% at 5 · +20 MS on hit	Path A second, always. E-Q + passive + autos stack it near-instantly, it layers with Q's 10-26% shred, and reduction is a debuff <i>on them</i> — your whole team hits the target harder. The anti-tank half of your kit.
 Profane Hydra 2850g	55 AD, 18 lethality, 10 AH · Cleave: basics splash 40% AD · active: 80% AD burst, 10s CD	Path B opener: the fastest clears J4 has, ganks with burst attached. Note: the execute on its active was removed — any guide still praising "Hydra executes" is stale.
 Axiom Arc 2750g	55 AD, 18 lethality, 20 AH · Flux: takedown within 3s refunds 10% (+0.25%/lethality) of R's total CD	Path B second. Chain-Cataclysm engine — a 2-takedown teamfight refunds ~40% of R with Profane's lethality aboard. Never without lethality friends (see box).
 Eclipse 2900g	60 AD · 2 hits on a champ within 2s: 6% max-HP physical + a shield, 6s CD	The bridge first item — E-Q + auto procs it instantly on the gank target. Keep Sundered as the follow-up.
 Serylda's Grudge 3000g	45 AD, 15 AH, 35% armor pen · slows sub-50%-HP targets 30%	Path B's anti-tank third (60.4% by-game WR when bought). Percent pen is what lethality isn't: worth most against high armor (+32% alone vs a 220-armor tank). VERIFIED Shop rule — Limited to 1 Fatality item: Serylda's, Black Cleaver, Last Whisper, Lord Dominik's, Mortal Reminder and Terminus share one group; you can never own two. So on Path A your anti-tank plan is Cleaver + your Q shred (~+50% together) — Serylda's isn't an option there. Duo tech: Cleaver's shred is a debuff <i>on the target</i> , so a teammate's Serylda's stacks with <i>your</i> Cleaver (~+60% for them).
 Edge of Night 3000g	50 AD, 250 HP, 15 lethality · spellshield, 40s recharge	Path B third vs pick comps: you jump in first, so the Morgana Q aimed at you eats the shield instead. Also +15 to the Flux refund math.
 Hubris 2800g	55 AD, 18 lethality, 10 AH · takedowns grant stacking AD (12 +3/stack for 90s)	Path B swap-in for Axiom <i>only</i> when hard snowballing (3+ kills pre-item). Pure win-more; loses to Axiom's utility otherwise.

4c · Boots & defense — the second half of every build

Slot	Choice	Notes
Boots	 Mercs /  Steelcaps	VERIFIED Steelcaps are picked more (48%) but Mercs win more (54.0% vs 51.9%; same gap at Gold). Pick by their damage profile — but when in doubt vs mixed comps, Mercs: you engage into the CC every fight.
3rd item (the pivot)	 Death's Dance	VERIFIED 58.5% at slot 3 (n=25,645) — the best third item on either path. 60 AD + 50 armor, damage taken is deferred, and a takedown cleanses the deferred damage entirely — in a chain-engage kit, every reset makes you briefly unkillable. After two damage items you pivot defensive: you're the engage button, and you die first if you don't.
The closer	 Guardian Angel	VERIFIED 64.3% at slot 3, 66.4% at slot 4 — heavily survivorship-inflated, but the pattern is real: when you're the first man in, a revive converts "engage and die" into "engage twice."
vs AP	 Maw ·  Rookern ·  Spirit ·  Visage	VERIFIED Maw when their burst is AP; Rookern (58.5% by-game) into sustained AP comps; Visage when you have a healer (it amplifies Sundered's heal too).
vs AD / crit	 Frozen Heart ·  Randuin's ·  Thornmail	VERIFIED Frozen Heart 54.6% at slot 3 vs attack-speed comps; Randuin's vs crit; Thornmail when their frontline heals. REASONING Every 400-HP defense item is also a bigger W — J4's tank items double-dip.
Anti-utility	 Serpent's Fang ·  Sterak's	VERIFIED Serpent's when two+ enemies stack shields; Sterak's when they burst you the instant you land (its shield + your W + DD deferral stack into real bulk). Note: Sterak's and Maw share the Lifeline group — the shop allows only one.

5 · The Clear — Season 2026 Timers

VERIFIED Patch 26.01 sped up the whole early jungle and most guides never updated: buffs now spawn at **0:55** (was 1:30), Gromp/Krugs at **1:07** (was 1:42), first scuttle at **2:55** (was 3:30). If a guide says "scuttle at 3:30," it's stale. Everything happens ~35s earlier now — including the enemy's invade window.

SINGLE SOURCE Standard route (jungler.gg 26.12, matches the lolalytics skill data): **Red brambleback (E first for attack speed) → Krugs → Raptors** — that's level 3 around 2:05–2:15, your first E-Q gank or scuttle window — **→ Wolves → Blue → Gromp**, full clear ~3:15–3:35 at level 4, then scuttle/gank. Start Raptors→Red→Krugs when you want the faster level-3 gank on bot side. **REASONING** E-Q the multi-camps (raptors, wolves, krugs) — the knockup path hits everything; drop E for its AS aura before big single targets. W on cooldown at buffs/Gromp to shave damage taken. Aim to end the first clear above 60% HP; time yourself once in practice tool.

Camp	First spawn	Respawn	Gold	XP
Blue Sentinel / Red Brambleback	0:55	5:00	90	95-142
Wolves / Raptors	0:55	2:15	85 / 75	80-120 / 70-105
Gromp / Krugs	1:07	2:15	80 / 81	120-180 / ~90-134
Rift Scuttler	2:55	2:30	55-121	100-150

VERIFIED against wiki camp pages 2026-07-06. Respawn timers become visible to *both* teams 60s out for buffs, 10s out for small camps — that's a tracking tool (§6). Camps level with the game's average, so late camps aren't XP-dead.

6 • When Your Jungle Isn't Yours

Your current habit, graded

REASONING "If I can't find camps I look for ganks" is **half right, and the half that's right is genuinely right** — Jarvan is a gank champion, and doing *something* beats standing in an empty jungle. The problem is the ungated version. A gank into a bad lane state gives you 0 gold and 0 XP **while the invader who took your camps farms freely** — you don't just fail to gain, you fall further behind on both ends. That's the compounding loss that turns one stolen camp into a lost jungle. The fix isn't "stop ganking" — it's a 10-second checklist before you commit, and a better default when the checklist fails.

6a • The gank checklist — go only on 2 or more

VERIFIED (Dodge.gg 2026 jungle guide) Count these before walking to a lane: **(1)** enemy pushed past the river line · **(2)** their Flash/escape is down · **(3)** your laner has CC to chain your knockup · **(4)** the wave is pushing toward your tower · **(5)** you have a level or item edge · **(6)** lane likely unwarded. **Fewer than two: don't go.** "A jungler who waits for the right gank outperforms a jungler who ganks constantly with low success." One more that's yours specifically: **REASONING** never gank a losing lane to "help" — you're feeding a shutdown into the player already beating your teammate.

6b · The four answers to an invade — in order

Play	When	How
1. Mirror-farm (the default)	You find a camp gone, or spot him entering your side	VERIFIED Don't chase — cross the map and take his matching camps . He took your Red side? His Red side is standing empty. Steal the big monster only and leave the smalls: the camp can't start its respawn timer, so his side stays dead longer. Get in, take it, get out — "each second in the enemy jungle is more dangerous than the last."
2. Counter-gank (the J4 special)	You <i>know</i> where he is (he's in YOUR jungle)	REASONING An invader's position is information. If he's eating your bot-side camps, he is not defending his top laner — and you have the best level-3 engage in the game. This is the disciplined version of your instinct: gank because you know where he isn't , not because your camps are gone. Checklist still applies.
3. Fight him (gated)	A laner can arrive before his does, OR you win the matchup	VERIFIED A 2v1 in your own jungle is a won fight — ping immediately, fight when they commit. But solo? J4 is a skirmisher with backup, not a duelist : Trundle, Poppy, Rek'Sai, Elise, Kindred, Bel'Veth all beat you isolated (\$7). No help + no matchup edge = walk away. "Take camps, not fights."
4. Concede & powerfarm (the reset)	Behind, low HP, or no good option	VERIFIED Swap to your opposite side and farm everything, toward the next objective spawn. The game pays you to do this: once you're >1.1 levels below average, every large monster gives +50 bonus XP per level you're behind . Catch-up XP refunds farming — it refunds nothing for wandering. Above all: don't die . Dying to the invader hands him your whole jungle on repeat.

6c · Track him so it stops happening

- **VERIFIED Loading screen:** level-1 invades come from hard-CC comps (Blitzcrank, Braum, Trundle, Olaf). See one? Expect your bot-side buff to be contested — start top-side, or ward your entrance at ~1:00 and stand in the river bush with your team.
- **VERIFIED Start-side detection:** if their bot lane shows up late to lane, they leashed — their jungler started bot-side. On time = top-side start. Now you know which of your camps he can reach and when.
- **VERIFIED The TAB rule:** each camp is 4 CS. Check his CS on the scoreboard: 8 = two camps, 12 = three camps and level 3 — **he can gank now**; 24 = full clear. Do this every time you back.
- **VERIFIED Ward at 3:00** — river or pixel brush, when first clears end and junglers start moving. Your own stolen camps help too: respawn timers show to both teams 60s out (buffs), so a visible timer on your Red tells you when he might come back for it. **REASONING** This is the \$1 callback: your last four games had **zero control wards**. A jungler who buys no pinks is invisible-blind in his own jungle — one control ward per back, planted at your most-invaded entrance, is the single cheapest fix to "I keep getting invaded." It's 75g for the information every rule in this chapter runs on.
- **VERIFIED Track intention, not just location.** A Kayn wants your camps; an Elise wants your laners at level 3. Knowing what he wants predicts where he'll be — and where you should be.

The math, so it sticks

VERIFIED One camp $\approx$ 75–90 gold + a chunk of a level (table in §5); small camps respawn every 2:15, so a farming jungler banks $\sim$ 3–4 camps' value in the time two failed roams take. A kill is worth 300g (400 first blood) plus XP — roughly 2–4 camps — **but only if it lands**, and an off-resources gank at Silver–Gold usually doesn't. Meanwhile his uncontested farm keeps flowing. **REASONING** The loop that beats invades long-term is boring: **Clear $\rightarrow$ ONE play $\rightarrow$ reset**. Farm what's up, make one checklist-approved play, recall, repeat. Windows where the "play" is strongest: level 3 ($\sim$ 2:15), after full clear ($\sim$ 3:30–4:00), your first-item spike, and level 6.

7 • Matchups

VERIFIED Numbers below are Emerald+ (the cut closest to your Plat 3, big samples). One nuance first: **duel-winners and game-winners are different lists**. Trundle beats you 1v1 in every early duel — yet J4 wins 55.9% of games vs Trundle (n=388), because good Jarvans just don't fight him and out-tempo the map. Losing the duel $\neq$ losing the game, as long as you refuse the duel.

vs You (Emerald+, 26.13)	WR (n)	Plan
Feast on: Locke · Volibear · Rammus · Trundle · Zed · Lillia · Zac	60.4 (3,471) · 57.4 (671) · 56.0 (1,046) · 55.9 (388) · 55.7 (1,595) · 55.3 (1,807) · 55.0 (1,770)	Play your normal tempo game — your engage outpaces them, or they need time you won't give. (Vs Trundle: win by refusing, see above.)
Your old tormentors: Viego · Kayn · Lee Sin · Graves	50.8 (7,260) · 51.8 (5,290) · 52.5 (11,868) · 50.4 (9,048)	VERIFIED The junglers who went a combined 0–7 against your Nunu are all even or J4-favored on Jarvan. You don't have to outfarm them anymore — you out-engage them. Skirmish 2v2 at scuttle with lane priority; your E-Q is the fight-starter Nunu never had.
Respect: Cho'Gath · Aatrox · Ivern · Talon · Nasus · Elise · Briar · Rek'Sai	46.9 (318) · 48.6 (1,135) · 49.0 (929) · 49.2 (3,671) · 49.4 (2,517) · 49.5 (1,576) · 49.8 (3,388) · 49.9 (1,267)	REASONING Two flavors: early bullies who beat you in skirmishes (Aatrox, Elise, Briar, Rek'Sai — don't duel, mirror-farm per §6) and scale-monsters (Cho, Nasus — kills aren't enough; convert every gank into grubs/dragon and press to end before 30, or your S-tier early game evaporates). At Gold-and-below the scaler problem gets even worse — games run longer and leads get wasted — so as a Plat player, closing speed is your edge.
Invade-duelists (they take YOUR camps): Trundle · Poppy · Rek'Sai · Elise · Kindred	duel-losers, game-winnable	SINGLE SOURCE Poppy W cancels your E-Q dash mid-flight; Trundle pillar traps you inside your own R; Rek'Sai/Elise out-duel you pre-6; Kindred wins if you over-commit. Vs all five: §6 rules — mirror-farm, don't duel, and ward your entrances because they're coming .